ERBIL DEMOGRAPHIC CHARACTERISTICS

Part I :
Erbil, ethnic mosaic

- Distribution of ethnicities
- Distribution of religions
- Distribution of spoken languages
- Distribution of immigrations and returns
- Compare of number of tourists

Part II :
Erbil's economic infrastructure from different branches

- Compare of average income and expenditure
- Compare of the number of households in the sample
- Distribution of import and export in Iraq

Part III :
Iraq's economic activity related to education and age ranges

- Distribution of persons by economic activity status
- Distribution of persons by educational level and sex, Iraq
- Distribution of persons by age ranges, Iraq
- Age and sex percent distribution in Erbil

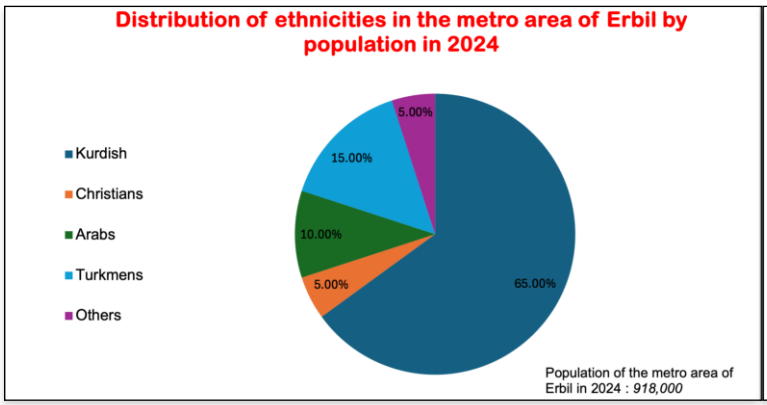


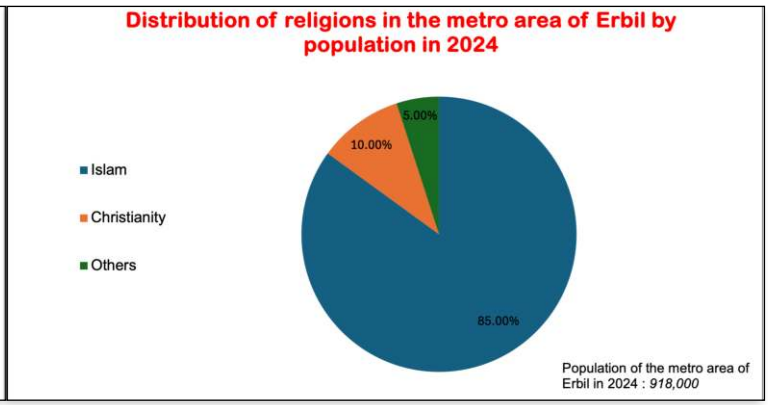
Erbil, the capital of the Kurdistan Region of Iraq, is a city marked by its rich historical legacy and dynamic demographic composition. In recent decades, the city has seen significant population growth driven by economic progress, internal migration and geopolitical factors. Together with Sulaimaniyah, they form the metropolitan area of the Kurdistan Regional Government which is the reason why we preferred to choose Sulaymaniyah to compare the stats of Erbil.

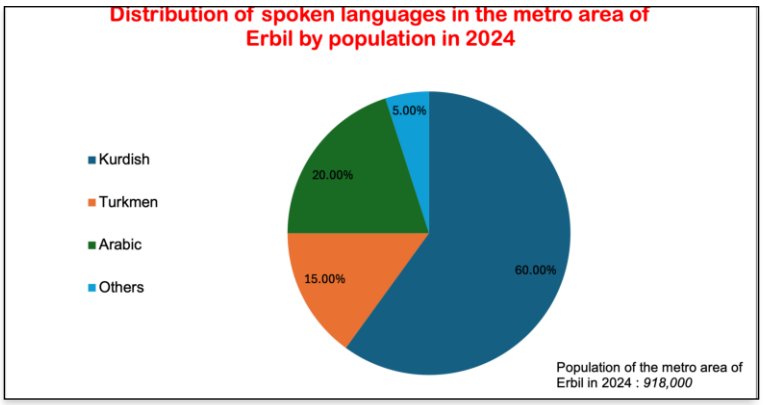
In this research, our main goal was to look the case from all kinds of perspectives and compare the results. Based on this idea, we separated the report to 3 different parts, which are exhibited in the column. The first part refers to the different ethnicities which are living and visiting Erbil. Furthermore, the second part is based on the economic situation of Erbil by comparing it with Sulaymaniyah's and the general situation of the Kurdistan Region of Iraq. Finally, the last part is formed by 2 different ideas to come to conclusion on the economic activity of Iraq, which are education and age ranges.

Understanding these demographic shifts is essential for assessing the city's social, economic, and political dynamics, as well as for planning sustainable urban development in one of the region's fastest-growing cities.

Part I : Erbil, ethnic mosaic

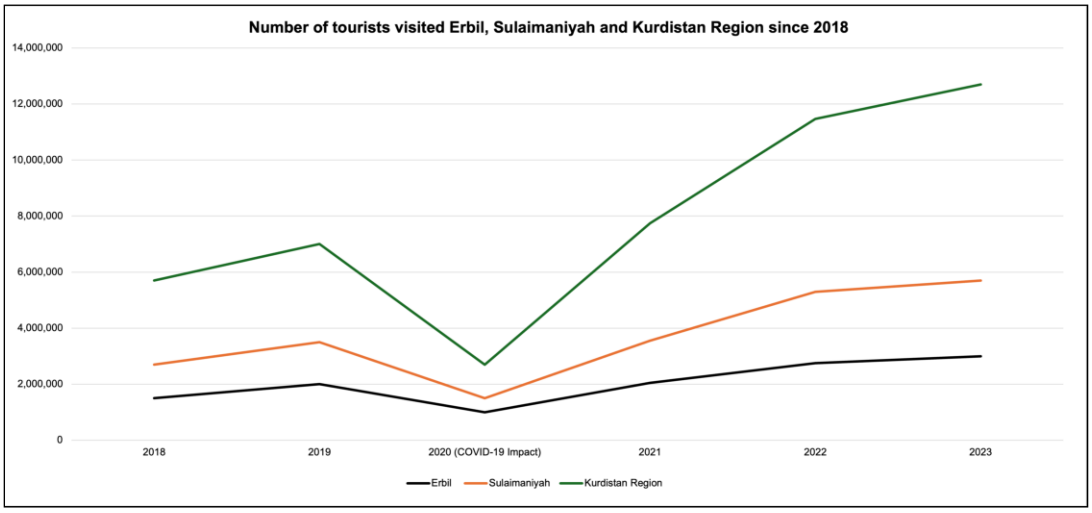




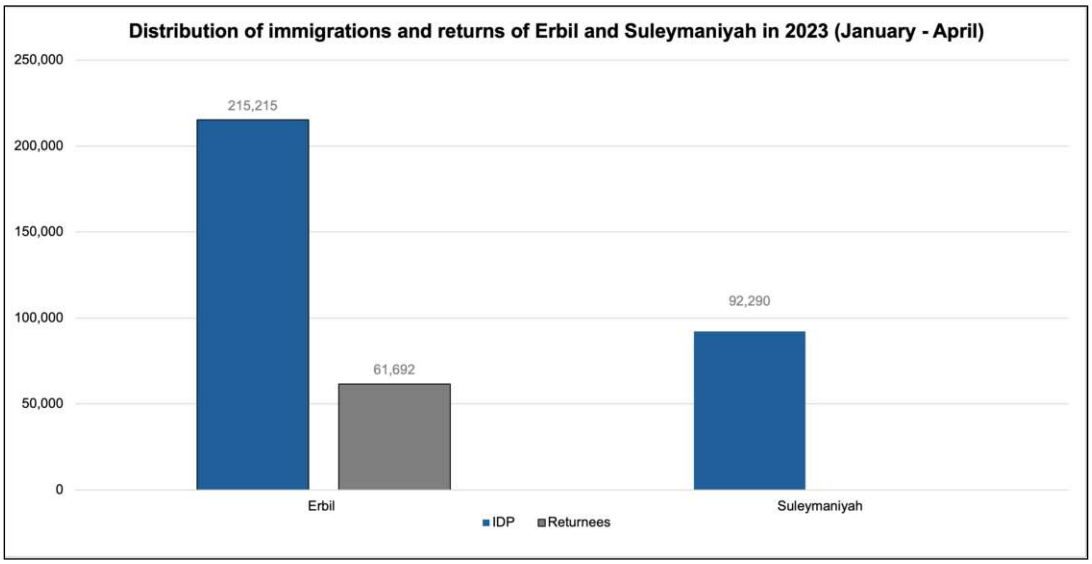


Erbil's demographic characteristics reflect a diverse blend of ethnicities, languages, and religious affiliations, including Kurds, Arabs, Assyrians, and Turkmen, among others.

When we examine the charts, the first on shows the distribution in the metro area of Erbil by population in 2024. Since the population of the metro area of Erbil in 2024 is 918.000, we can determine that more than half of it is formed by Kurdish people (65.00%). Turkmens make up 15% and arabs 10%, while Christians make up 5% and Christians make up the remaining 5%. Based on these percentages and then chart which shows the distribution of religions in the metro area of Erbil by population in 2024, we can also draw a conclusion about the religious preferences of the community living in Erbil. Therefore, 88.00 % of the population living in the metro area of Erbil in 2024 is part of the Islam community. The Christian community creates 10% of the population while other religions make up the remaining 5%. Lastly, the final chart shows us the distribution of spoken languages in the metro area of Erbil by population in 2024. Since the Kurds are in the majority, 60.00% of population speaks Kurdish, whereas 20.00% speaks Arabic. Unlike Kurds, the Turkmens and others are in minority, so their languages are spoken less. (Turkmen : 15.00% ; Others : 5.00%).

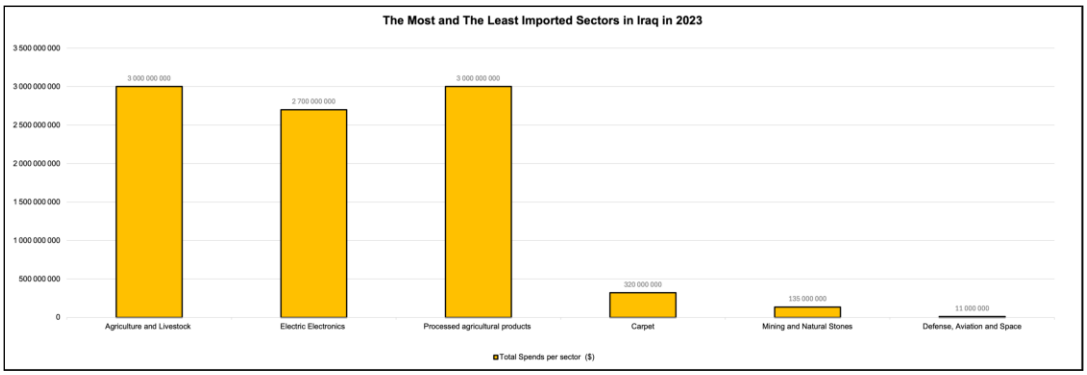


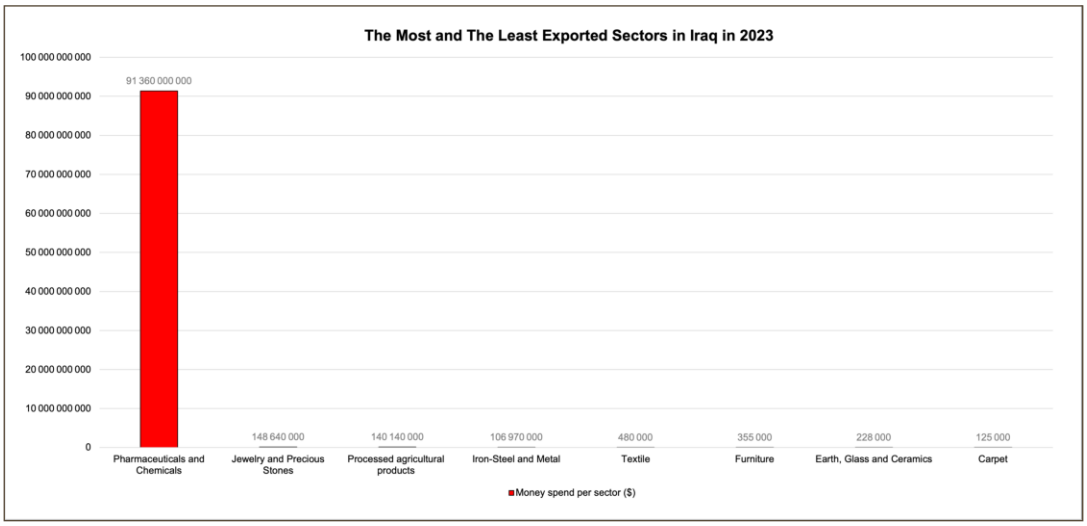
The graphic shown above is a linear graphic which shows the changes that happened on the number of tourists visited Erbil, Sulaimaniyah and Kurdistan Region since 2018. All 3 regions we have examined have rising profiles in the field of tourism, so the number of tourists they receive has been steadily increasing over the years. The reason behind this, especially for Erbil, is that it is built on a historical site. The point where the regions could not benefit from the tourism sector and the numbers bottomed out was the Corona virus pandemic period that was experienced all over the world in 2020.With people staying at home and travel restrictions being imposed, the tourism industry has suffered and many countries have experienced the same situation and have not received the income from the tourism industry that they had hoped for in the past years.



Another factor that makes Erbil an ethnic mosaic is immigrations. The graphic above shows the distribution of immigrations to Erbil and Sulaimaniyah in 2023, especially between January - April. In addition, it shows the returns to Erbil but not the ones who returned to Sulaimaniyah because there wasn't any in the period between January - April in 2023. As shown in the graphic, Erbil's internal displacement is quite high with an IDP of 215,215, whereas the ones of Sulaimaniyah is 92,290. However, the other difference between them is Erbil shows a number of returns of 61,692, whereas Sulaimaniyah has none.

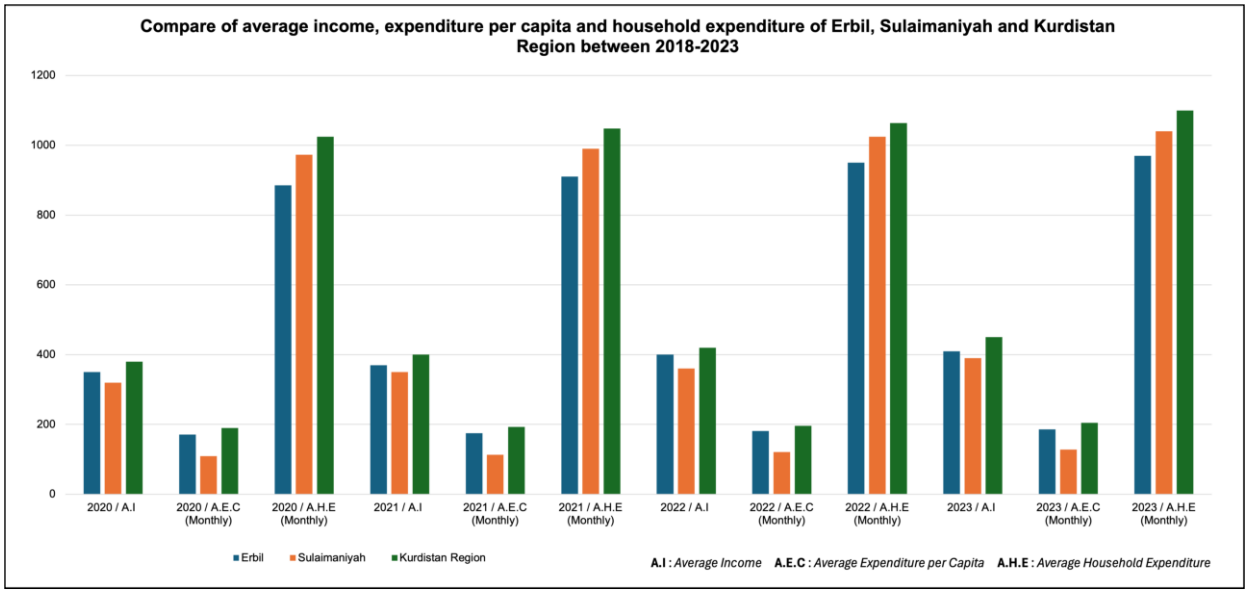
Part II : Erbil & Iraq's economic infrastructure from different branches



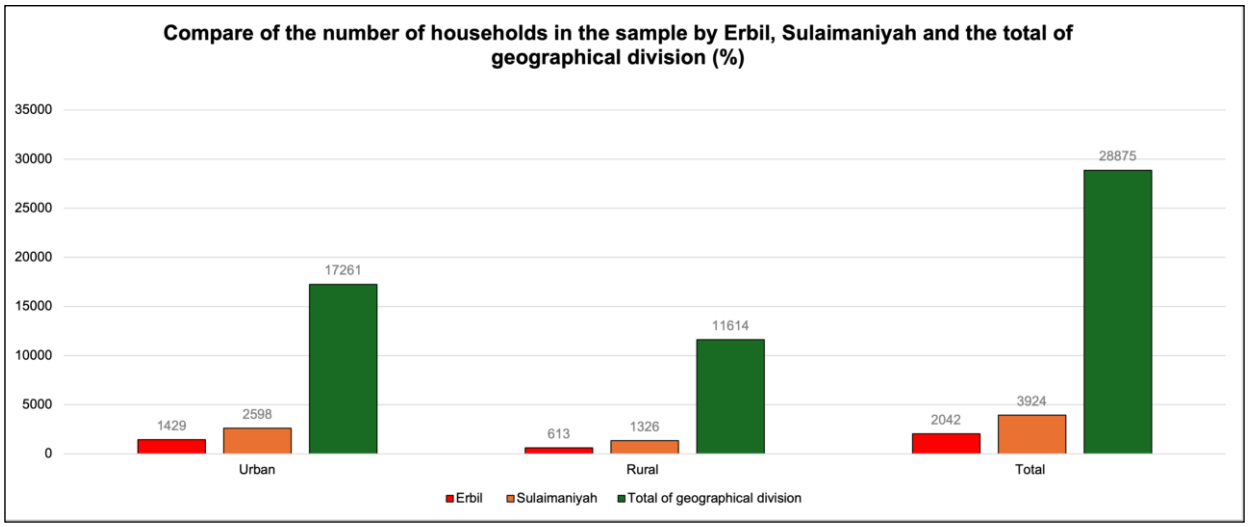


The economy of a city is directly linked to the economy of the country in which it is located. For this reason, in the second part of this report, we will make use of the general economic structure and data of Iraq while analyzing the economy of Erbil from different branches. The field we call economy is actually the circulation of money in the simplest terms. When we analyze the economy of a house, we talk about income and expenditure. In the same way, when we talk about the economy of a country, we talk about the sales and purchases of that country to foreign countries, which is, exports and imports.

The two graphs shown above are interconnected. One of them shows the most and the least *imported* sectors in Iraq in 2023, other shows the most and the least *exported* sectors in Iraq in 2023. From the first graphic, we can come to a conclusion that the main sectors that Iraq imports are : Agriculture and Livestock ; Electric Electronics ; Processed agricultural products. As a comment, we can say that Iraq has not developed sufficiently in the field of agriculture and has not been able to get the necessary yield from its soil. For this reason, they have become dependent on foreign countries in this sector with high expenditures (around 8.7 billion $ in total) on agriculture and electrical electronics. Unlike these sectors, the ones that Iraq imports the least are : Carpet ; Mining and Naturel Stones ; Defense, Aviation and Space. Iraq spend a total of $466 million in 2023 on imports for these sectors. On the other hand, the second graph indicates a very specific sector for Iraq's main resource on their exports : Pharmaceuticals and Chemicals. The country made around 91.3 billion $ from this sector in 2023.

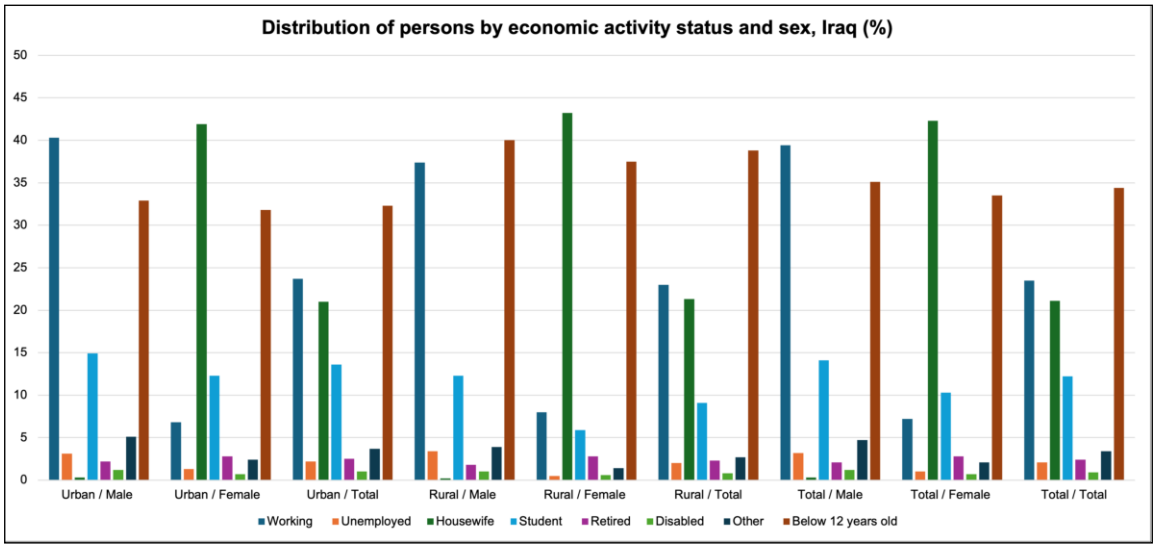


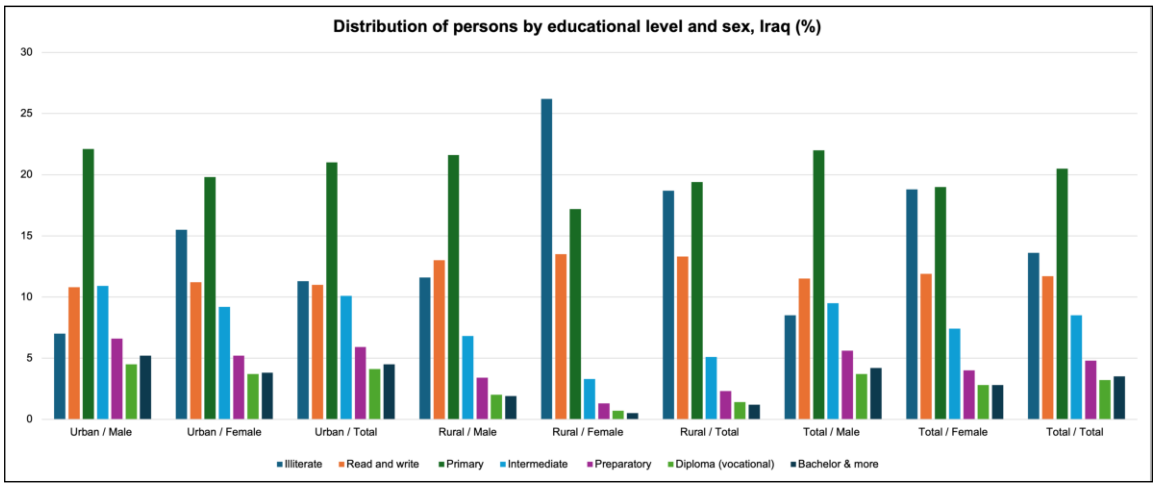
The graphic show above is an analysis of the average income and expenditure of Erbil, Sulaimaniyah and Kurdistan Region, detailed with the expenditure per capita and household. As the years go by, we observe that average income, expenditure and average household expenditure have increased for both cities, and naturally for Kurdistan as a whole. It is noteworthy that while the average income and expenditure per capita in Erbil is higher than in Sulaimaniyah, the household expenditure in Sulaimaniyah is higher than in Erbil. This is because of the number of households in Sulaimaniyah which is greater than Erbil.



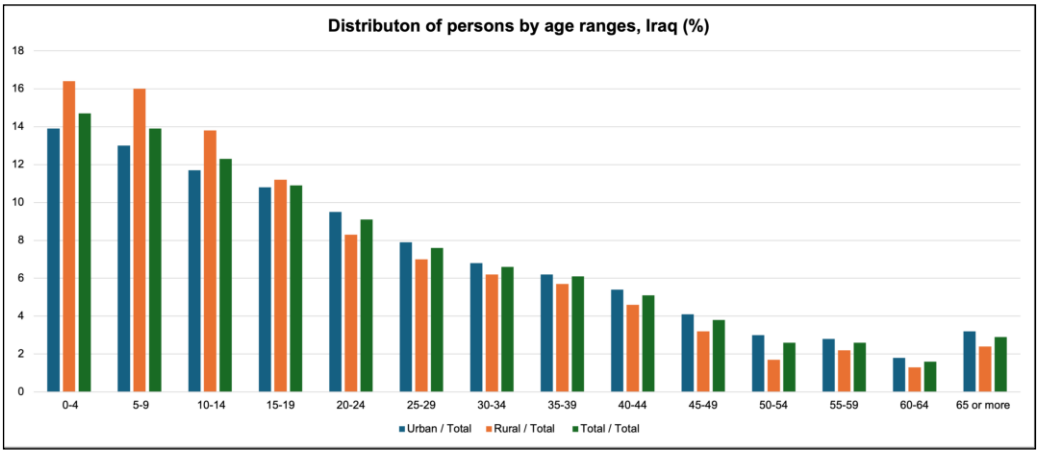
The graphics above compares the number of households in the urban and the rural parts of the city in the sample by Erbil, Sulaimaniyah and the total of geographical division in percentage. As we mentioned above, Sulaimaniyah has much more households compared to Erbil, in rural, urban and in total. To put it in numbers, Erbil has 1429 households in urban and 613 in rural which makes 2042 in total. On the other side, Sulaimaniyah has 2598 households in urban abd 1326 in rural which makes 3924 in total. The total of geographical division has 17261 households in urban and 11614 in rural, so 28875 in total.

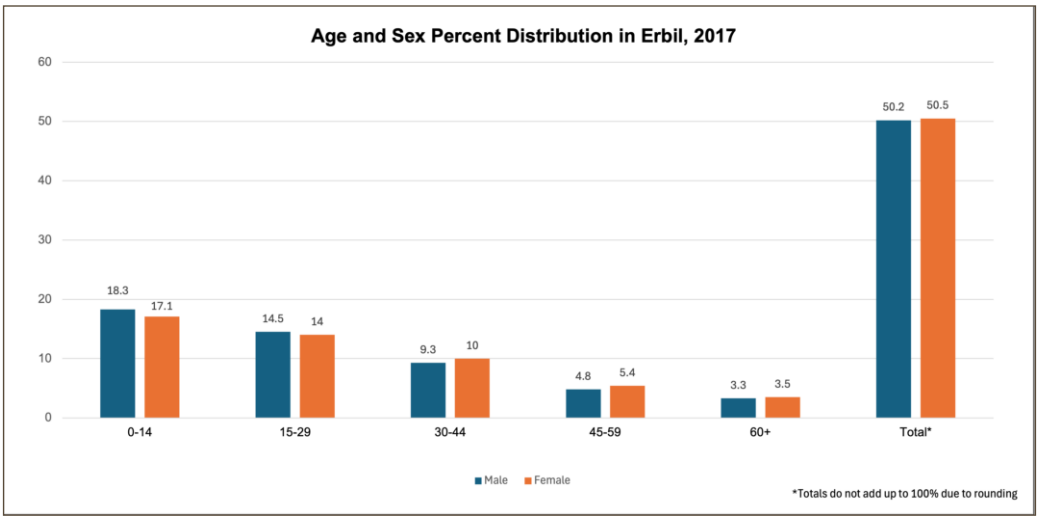
Part III : Iraq's economic activity related to education and age ranges





The economic activity and education level are both related to each other. It is the level of education that determines economic activity. Therefore, we aim to reach the healthiest conclusions by taking these 2 graphs together. The first graph shows the distribution of persons by economic activity and sex in Iraq in percentage. We can tell that in urban, men are the ones who works and women are ones who takes care of the home and the children below 12 years old which are quite a lot. In rural, the situation stays the same. The difference between urban and rural is that female student that lives in urban are more tended to go to school rather than the ones that lives in rural. Of course we can't know the main raison but another possibility is that in rural families may force their daughters to stay at home. The second graph shows the distribution of persons by educational level and sex in Iraq in percentage. As shown in the graph, most of the population has a primary level education. The exceptional case is that the majority of illiterate people are female, both urban and rural.





Age is also one of the factors that we should pay attention to when analyzing economic activity. If the average age of a city or a country is high, the working population there is low because people have retired. On the contrary, if the average age is very low, then people have not yet reached the maturity to work. For this reason, when analyzing economic activity, we can also consider the age ranges and observe the age range of the people in which the region is productive. If we draw a path from general to specific, we will first analyze the general age graph of Iraq. Then we will move to the small scale and focus on Erbil.

On top, we have a graphic demonstrating the distribution of persons by age ranges in Iraq, in percentage. Looking at the graph, we can say that the child (0-14) population is quite high, the young (15-29) and middle-aged (30-49) population is average, and the elderly (50-65 or more) population is quite small. This also shows us that the fertility of women in Iraq is very high. Moving on to the second graphic, showing the distribution of age and sex in Erbil in 2017 in percentage, we see a similar result. Again, as in the Iraqi graph, we observe a population accumulation at young ages and a population dilution at older ages.

What this graph shows us is that the male population is in the majority at a young age and as the years pass and people age, the female population becomes the majority. This is actually a well-known situation throughout the world, but this graph provides us with data that proves that men live less than women.